

TIME TABLE

I. TIME TABLE:

1. INTRODUCTION TO TIME TABLING

Purpose & Philosophy

- Time table is the **baseline schedule** for all coaching train operations.
 - It ensures:
 - Passenger convenience (timings, connections).
 - Operational efficiency (paths, margins, sectional capacity).
 - Integration of rolling stock, crew, maintenance, and terminal constraints.
 - Annual optimisation of IR's network.
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2. TYPES OF TIME TABLES

- **Public Time Table (PTT)** — Published timings for passenger use, includes fares, rules, amenities, updated also on NTES.
 - **Working Time Table (WTT)** — Detailed staff document with sectional information, loads, PSRs, JPOs, allowances.
 - **Suburban TT**
 - **Sheet TT**
 - **Military TT** — Specialised formats.
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3. FUNDAMENTAL PRINCIPLES OF TIME TABLE PREPARATION

3.1 Passenger-Centric Criteria

- Convenient departures/arrivals.
- Reasonable transit times.
- Adequate time for entraining/detraining.
- Balanced needs of short, medium, long-distance passengers.

3.2 Service / Operational Requirements

- Maintenance slots (primary, secondary, OEM).
 - Platform availability.
 - Watering, fueling, catering logistics.
 - Integration of stock, locos, crew availability.
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4. ANNUAL TIME TABLE CYCLE (KEY CONCEPT)

- Operating Manual clearly states: **“Time tables are usually published once in a year.”**

Major reviews conducted annually to reflect:

- Infrastructure upgrades (track, signaling, traction).
 - Rolling stock improvements.
 - Passenger feedback.
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5. THE FORMAL PROCESS OF TIME TABLE PREPARATION

STEP-WISE PROCESS

Step 1 — Data Collection & Drafting at Division

- Inputs from:
 - Ticket sale data
 - Passenger associations (DRUCC)
 - Local bodies / leaders
 - Proposals include:
 - New trains, extensions
 - Additional stoppages
 - Augmentation
 - Elimination of halts
 - Timing revisions
 - Each proposal must show **stock/loco/path/crew requirement**.
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Step 2 — Consolidation at Zonal HQ

- Divisional proposals reviewed at HQ.
 - Inputs taken from concerned departments (Mechanical, Electrical, Engineering, S&T).
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Step 3 — Inter-Railway Coordination (IRTTCC)

- **Inter Railway Time Table Co-ordination Committee Meeting** chaired by ED/Coaching, RB.
- CPTMs of all Railways participate.

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- Decisions included into Railway Budget.
- Approved items implemented in the new TT.

6. OFFICIAL TIME FRAME FOR TIME TABLE PREPARATION

6.1 The Official Timeline (MONTH-WISE)

S.No.	Activity	Time Frame
1	Divisions finalise proposals (timings + stock/loco/crew requirement)	September
2	Minutes of Divisional TT Meeting to CPTM	October
3	CPTM meeting with Mechanical, Electrical, Engg, S&T	November
4	CPTM meeting with RMS authorities	November
5	CPTM meeting with Sr.DOMs (DRUCC & ZRUCC inputs considered)	December
6	Inter Railway Time Table Committee Meeting (IRTTCC)	Feb–March
7	Order to print Time Table	15th May
8	Publication to Public (PTT released)	1st June

Thus, the official PTT preparation cycle runs from SEPTEMBER → JUNE.

7. ADDITIONAL PROVISIONS IN OPERATING MANUAL

7.1 Interim Changes

- Mega blocks

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- Engineering works
 - Accidents, disruptions
 - Temporary diversions, cancellations, duplications
 - Clone trains in peak seasons
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8. SUMMARY FOR AOM LDCE 30% / TRAINING MODULE

8.1 Critical Learning Points

- Time Table is revised **annually**.
 - Follows a structured, multi-stage approval process.
 - Integrates:
 - Passenger demand
 - Operational feasibility
 - Maintenance needs
 - Rolling stock availability
 - Crew working rules
 - Inter-zonal synchronisation
 - Official timeline is **strictly defined** from **September to June**.
 - Inter Railway Time Table Co-ordination Committee (IRTTCC) is the apex body for finalisation.
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9. EXAM-READY 4–LINE SUMMARY

“Time Table preparation in Indian Railways is an annual, structured process beginning with divisional proposals in September and culminating in public

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release on 1st June. The Operating Manual mandates multi-departmental vetting, zonal consolidation, and nationwide approval through the Inter Railway Time Table Coordination Committee (Feb–March). Printing orders are issued by 15th May, ensuring readiness of all operational links before PTT comes into force.”

II. INTER-RAILWAY TIME TABLE CO-ORDINATION COMMITTEE (IRTTCC) MEETING WITH RAILWAY BOARD

1. What is IRTTCC?

The **Inter-Railway Time Table Coordination Committee** is the **apex national body** that finalises all Time Table–related decisions across Indian Railways.

It is the **only forum** where all Zonal Railways sit together under the **Railway Board’s Directorate (Coaching)** to harmonise train timings across zones.

1. 1 ROLE & PURPOSE OF IRTTCC

The **Inter-Railway Time Table Coordination Committee (IRTTCC)** is the **apex national body** responsible for finalising the **All-India Time Table**, including:

- Public Time Table (PTT) of all zones
- Working Time Tables (WTT)
- Trains At A Glance (TAAG)
- Inter-zonal timings, pathing, halts, and speed-ups

It ensures **uniformity, synchronisation, and feasibility** of all coaching services across **Indian Railways + KRCL + Military Railways (MILRAIL)**.

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2. MEMBERS OF IRTTCC

“Inter Railway Time Table Co-ordination Committee Meeting ... presided by ED (Coaching), with Director (Coaching) as Secretary and CPTMs of all Railways as members.”

3. Composition of IRTTCC

Chairman

- **Executive Director (Coaching), Railway Board**

Member-Secretary

- **Director (Coaching), Railway Board**

Members

(a) CPTMs of all Zonal Railways

- **All Chief Passenger Transportation Managers (CPTMs) represent their zones.**
- **They bring zonal proposals, capacity inputs, crew/rake constraints, and halt/connection rationalisation.**

(b) Representative from Konkan Railway Corporation Ltd. (KRCL)

- **KRCL operates independently from IR Zones.**
- **Presence ensures synchronisation of trains running over Roha–Thokur KRCL section.**

(c) Representative from MILRAIL

- **MILRAIL (Military Railway Service Wing) ensures:**
 - **Movement of military specials**
 - **Integration of defence requirements**
 - **Avoidance of conflicts with coaching/freight paths**

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(d) Executive Director Mechanical Engineering (ED/ME)

- **Represents Mechanical Directorate**
- **Provides input on:**
 - **Rolling stock availability**
 - **Maintenance slots**
 - **Rake links**
 - **Turn-round feasibility**

(e) IRCA – General Secretary

- **Indian Railways Conference Association (IRCA)**
 - **Ensures:**
 - **Uniformity of route codes**
 - **Inter-system fare tables**
 - **National standardisation across zones**
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4. Objectives / Purpose of IRTTCC

4.1 Harmonisation Across Zones

- Consolidates all Zonal proposals (new trains, timings, extensions, halts, cancellations).
- Ensures **cross-zonal feasibility**, avoiding conflict at interchange points.

4.2 Policy & Strategic Alignment

- Integrates:
 - Network capacity
 - Rolling stock availability
 - Crew & loco links

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- Maintenance windows
- Pathing across multiple zones

4.3 Budget Integration

- As per OM: “Decisions taken in this meeting are **proposed in the Railway Budget.**”

4.4 Finalisation of Annual Time Table

- Determines what changes will finally appear in the **All-India Time Table** (WTT + PTT + TAAG).
 - Coordinates implementation schedule.
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5. Timing of the IRTTCC Meeting (Annual Cycle)

According to the Operating Manual’s **Time Line for Revision:**

- **February–March** → IRTTCC Meeting
(This is the *national-level finalisation stage* before printing and publication.)

Cited lines:

6. Inputs to IRTTCC (Flow of Proposals)

6.1 Divisional Inputs (September — December)

- New trains
- Extensions
- Additional halts
- Stoppage rationalisation
- Augmentation
- Revised timings

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- Crew/locomotive/path requirement

6.2 Zonal Consolidation (November–December)

- CPTM reviews with:
 - Engg
 - S&T
 - Mechanical
 - Electrical
 - RMS
- DRUCC/ZRUCC suggestions incorporated.

6.3 IRTTCC Level (February–March)

- All zones present their consolidated proposals.
- Railway Board tables:
 - Network capacity constraints
 - Inter-zonal conflicts
 - Policy directions
 - Pending works affecting paths
 - Stock availability
 - Terminal restrictions

7. Output of the IRTTCC

7.1 Approved Time Table Changes

- New trains to be introduced
- Change of timings

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- Withdrawal/shift of halts
- Extensions/augmentations
- Path rationalisation across zones
- Special category trains (premium, Vande Bharat, Rajdhani restructuring)

7.2 Instructions for Implementation

- Final freeze of WTT/TT
- Rake links & crew links to be re-worked by zones
- Data to be updated in:
 - ICMS
 - COA
 - NTES
 - PRS/UTS
 - TAAG/Zone PTT printing modules

7.3 Printing Authorization

- After IRTTCC finalisation,
“Orders shall be given to print Time Table” on 15th May.

8. Strategic Importance of the IRTTCC Meeting

8.1 Only platform to solve inter-zonal conflicts

- Multiple zones share major trunk routes. Without IRTTCC:
 - Path clashes
 - Terminal congestion
 - Congested nodes (Itarsi, Vijayawada, Mughalsarai, Jhansi, Chennai, Delhi)

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- Cross-zone inconsistencies in running time allowances

8.2 Maintains national timetable consistency

Ensures that all zones follow a **uniform national logic** for:

- Speed
- Stoppage policy
- Superfast categorisation
- Public Time Table alignment
- Zero-Based Time Tabling evaluation

8.3 Budget Relevance

- Trains whose demand is politically or commercially significant are finalised here, after due feasibility testing.

8.4 Ensures operational realism

- Availability of:
 - Crew
 - Locomotives
 - Rakes
 - Maintenance windows
 - Line capacityis examined at the apex level.

9. Exam-Ready Summary (4 Lines)

IRTTCC is the apex national forum chaired by ED/Coaching, RB, where all CPTMs meet to harmonise, finalise, and approve annual Time Table changes. It is held in February–March each year. Its decisions become part of the Railway Budget and lead directly to printing and publication of the WTT/PTT. It ensures

TIME TABLE

cross-zonal synchronisation, operational feasibility, and national uniformity in train operations.

III. TRAINS AT A GLANCE (TAAG)

1. WHAT IS TRAINS AT A GLANCE (TAAG)?

TAAG is the **All-India Public Time Table** of Indian Railways.

It is the **most authoritative national publication** for all long-distance train timings, routes, days of run, classes, distance tables, and passenger information across IR.

It is:

- A **nationally consolidated PTT**,
- Not zone-wise,
- Published once a year,
- Available in **print** and **digital** formats.

WTT = Division-For Staff

PTT = Zonal

TAAG = All India

2. PURPOSE & IMPORTANCE OF TAAG

2.1 For Passengers

- One-stop reference for:
 - Timings of all important long-distance trains
 - Route maps
 - Classes of accommodation

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- Duration of journey
- Days of run
- Connections & interchange stations
- Fare tables and reservation rules
- Special amenities and safety instructions

2.2 For Railway Operations

- Acts as a **national benchmark** for:
 - Inter-zonal coordination
 - Planning horizon for divisions/zones
 - Crew/stock link planning
 - Publicity of new trains
 - Rationalisation of halts & paths

2.3 For Commercial Department

- Official reference for:
 - Fare rules
 - Classes & coach composition
 - Concession rules
 - Break-of-journey norms
 - Citizen charter—related content

3. CONTENTS OF TRAINS AT A GLANCE

TAAG contains:

3.1 Train Timings Section

- All-important long-distance trains of IR

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- Major & important intermediate stoppages
- Arrival/Departure timings
- Days of run (Mon/Tue/...)
- Origin–Destination mileage & total distance
- Journey time

3.2 Zone-wise Route Maps

- Highly detailed colour maps showing:
 - Main trunk routes (NDLS–CSTM, NDLS–HWH, NDLS–MAS, etc.)
 - Important junctions
 - Inter-city corridors
 - Tourist routes

3.3 Reservation Information

- PRS/UTS reservation rules
- Tatkal scheme
- Child fare rules
- Quotas
- On-board accommodation rules

3.4 Passenger Amenities Information

- Catering, onboard services
- Safety instructions
- Rail tourism products
- Cleanliness norms
- Contact numbers & helplines

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3.5 Miscellaneous

- Holiday schedules
 - Metro/EMU connection tables
 - Index of train names & train numbers
 - Alphabetical station index
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4. PREPARATION OF TAAG (LINKED WITH TIME TABLE REVISION PROCESS)

TAAG is **finalised only after**:

1. **Divisional TT proposals (Sept)**
2. **Zonal consolidation (Oct–Dec)**
3. **IRTTC Meeting (Feb–March)**
4. **Railway Board approval**
5. **Printing order (15 May)**
6. **Publication to public (1 June)**

This means TAAG reflects:

- All approved new trains
 - Adjusted timings
 - Halt rationalisation
 - Route changes
 - Speed increases
 - Changes from ZBTT (Zero-Based Time Tabling)
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5. DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION OF TAAG

Today TAAG is available via:

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5.1 NTES (National Train Enquiry System)

- Dynamic/real-time data
- Also hosts **static time table** extracted from TAAG

5.2 IRCTC Website & Mobile App

- Cross-linked to timetable data

5.3 e-Book / PDF TAAG

- Official downloadable version from IR portal

5.4 GIS-Based Route Maps

- Railways introduced improved maps for passenger awareness

6. TAAG vs PUBLIC TIME TABLE (PTT)

Aspect	PTT (Zonal)	TAAG (All India)
Coverage	One Zone	Entire IR
Train coverage	All coaching trains incl. passenger	Only important long-distance trains
Detail level	Very detailed	Summarised
Use	Local passenger planning	Nationwide journey planning
Frequency	Annual	Annual

7. ROLE OF TAAG IN AOM / OPERATING MANAGEMENT

7.1 Connecting Inter-Zonal Planning

AOMs use TAAG for:

- Path analysis
- Connection viability

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- Inter-zonal train handling
- Holiday/weekend loads

7.2 Operational Constraints

- Terminals with short turn-rounds
- Maintenance windows
- Direction reversal points
- Doubling/tripling in progress

All reflected indirectly via TAAG timings.

7.3 Passenger Demand Analysis

- Seasonal surges
- Tourist hubs
- Pilgrimage traffic
- Corridor-wise saturation patterns

7.4 Policy Inputs

- New trains
- Frequency enhancement
- Speed-up proposals
- Stoppage rationalisation

8. EXAM-ORIENTED SHORT NOTES

8.1 Summary

Trains At A Glance (TAAG) is the All-India Public Time Table of Indian Railways, published annually by the Railway Board. It consolidates timings of important long-distance trains, national route maps, reservation rules, fare details, and passenger amenities information. It is released after the IRTTCC and finalisation of

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WTT/PTT. TAAG is the national benchmark for passenger information and inter-zonal operational planning.

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IV. BOOKING OF SPECIAL TOURIST COACHES / SALOONS / SPECIAL TRAINS ON FULL TARIFF RATES (FTR)

1. INTRODUCTION

The booking of:

- Special Tourist Coaches
- Saloons
- Special Trains

on **Full Tariff Rates (FTR)** is governed by a centralised online booking system operated **exclusively by IRCTC**, acting as the **single-window agency** on behalf of Indian Railways.

2. SINGLE-WINDOW BOOKING THROUGH IRCTC

2.1 Mandatory Routing

- All bookings on FTR **must be made only through IRCTC**.
- No Divisional / Station commercial counters may accept such requests.

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- **EXCEPTION:** *Manual booking allowed only for Paramilitary & Defence Forces.*

2.2 Who can book?

- Individuals
 - Private parties
 - Tourist groups
 - Government Departments
 - Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs)
 - State Government agencies
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3. HOW TO BOOK (Procedure)

Step 1 – Registration

Requesting party must register:

- **Online via IRCTC FTR Portal, OR**
- Through IRCTC Regional / Zonal / Headquarters Offices (via email, telephone, written request)

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Step 2 – Submission of Indent

Details required:

- Date of journey
- Route & destination
- Number & type of coaches
- Purpose of travel
- Contact details

Step 3 – IRCTC Coordination

IRCTC performs:

- Registration of indent in system
- Liaison with Railway zones/divisions
- Obtaining:
 - Path feasibility
 - Availability of coaches
 - Rate advice from nominated officers

TIME TABLE

- Communicating fare estimate to the party

Step 4 – Payment & Confirmation

The party must deposit:

- Security deposit
- Estimated fare
- Applicable taxes & charges

After payment:

- IRCTC issues FTR receipt & confirmation.

Step 5 – Journey & Post-Journey Formalities

After completion, IRCTC:

- Submits folder/receipt to Railways
- Coordinates settlement of outstanding dues
- Processes cancellation (if applicable)

4. BOOKING TIME LIMITS

TIME TABLE

- **Minimum:** 1 month before date of journey
 - **Maximum:** 6 months before date of journey
 - No bookings outside these limits.
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5. APPLICABLE CHARGES (FTR CHARGES)

(a) Security Deposit

- ₹50,000 per coach (refundable subject to conditions)

(b) Point-to-Point Fare

- Charged on **round-trip basis**
- Even if the return is empty, charges apply.

(c) Service Charge

- **30% service charge** on point-to-point round-trip fare (Railways levy this; IRCTC levies an additional 5% facilitation charge)

(d) Empty Haulage Charge

- Minimum **200 km** chargeable

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- Applied when:
 - Empty positioning (to starting point)
 - Empty withdrawal (after completion)

(e) Detention Charges

- Charged when coach/train is detained for reasons attributable to the party.
- Includes **coach detention** and **engine detention**.

(f) IRCTC Facilitation Fee

- **5% of total fare** for coordination, registration & administrative work.

(g) GST

- **5% GST** applicable for **AC & First Class** coaches.

(h) Superfast Charges

- Levied if train is given a **superfast path** or runs as a superfast special.
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6. IMPORTANT CONDITIONS

6.1 No Concessions

- No fare concession allowed for:
 - Senior citizens
 - Children
 - Students
 - Medical cases
 - Govt. servants

6.2 Mandatory Online Booking

- UTS / manual bookings not allowed except Defence/Paramilitary.

6.3 Cancellation Rules

- IRCTC processes:
 - Cancellation request
 - Refund of security deposit (subject to conditions)
 - Deduction of cancellation charges (as per Railway rules)

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6.4 Railways' Right to Cancel

If path not available, block restrictions, or safety reasons —
Railways may cancel the booking; charges refunded except service charges.

7. RESPONSIBILITIES OF IRCTC

IRCTC acts as the **intermediary** between passenger and Railways:

- Registering FTR request
- Coordinating with concerned zones
- Obtaining:
 - Coach availability
 - Path feasibility
 - Rate advice
- Communicating fare and conditions to the party
- Collecting charges
- Issuing confirmation

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- Coordinating journey completion documents
 - Processing post-journey accounts
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8. EXAM-READY SUMMARY (4 Lines)

All saloons, tourist coaches and special trains on FTR are booked only via IRCTC's single-window system. Booking must be made between 1 to 6 months in advance with a deposit of ₹50,000 per coach, round-trip fare, 30% service charge, empty haulage, detention and GST charges. IRCTC levies 5% facilitation fee for coordination. No concessions are allowed for any category of passenger.